Q+A

STILL IN THE GROOVE

From playing an old-school romantic in *Never Kiss Your Best Friend* (ZEE5) to the profit-driven head of an app in *Escaype Live* (Disney+ Hotstar), **Jaaved Jaaferi** is showing he hasn't lost his touch



MANDAR DEODHAR

Q. Your new show looks at the world of social media and apps. What is your relationship with social media like?
I am not much on social media anymore. I was very active on Twitter, but I got off it for a bit because there was too much hate and darkness coming in.

Q. What did you enjoy about playing Bittu Mama (*Never Kiss...*) and the very different Ravi Gupta (*Escaype Live*)?
Through the very confident Ravi Gupta, we see how corporations look at their users and numbers. The question of 'do ends justify the means' often comes up. Bittu Mama, on the other hand, is a hopeless romantic...a very loving, Punjabi character.

Q. With characters exploring the spaces between black and white today, has it become harder to distinguish between antagonist and protagonist?
A film's length would require leaving things out. But a series can explore all the complexities of the characters across eight hours, going wider and deeper. That is a big advantage for actors and creative people.

Q. After 35-plus years in the entertainment industry, are you where you want to be?
Sometimes you feel you could have been more, but then you feel gratitude for what you have. That keeps you sane and balanced. I have gone through the whole shebang—slapstick to weird comedy to dark to villain to serious, responsible cinema. Things are at an interesting juncture now.

—with Udita Jhunjhunwala